

Incident Report: Scheduled task persistence with payload execution

Alert ID	log-scheduled-task-persistence
Severity	CRITICAL
Score	80/100
Source	log_analysis
MITRE	T1053.005, T1204

Executive Summary

Task \Microsoft\Windows\UpdateHealth\WinUpdateCheck created persistence and executed C:\ProgramData\WindowsUpdate\updater.exe.

Evidence

scheduled_task_created_microsoft_windows_updatehealth_winupdatec (+35) - Scheduled task created: \Microsoft\Windows\UpdateHealth\WinUpdateCheck

task_points_to_writable_programdata_payload_c_programdata_window (+20) - Task points to writable ProgramData payload: C:\ProgramData\WindowsUpdate\updater.exe

scheduled_task_payload_executed_after_creation (+25) - Scheduled task payload executed after creation

Timeline

2026-08-17T08:17:22Z | evt-010 | event=4698 | A scheduled task was created.

2026-08-17T08:17:51Z | evt-011 | event=1 | Process Create.

2026-08-17T08:48:04Z | evt-012 | event=1 | Process Create.

Recommended Actions

- Delete the scheduled task
- Hash and quarantine the payload
- Hunt for matching task names and payload paths across endpoints